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Intel has 1000 employees working for the SoC that may power up the next iPhone
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Dropbox's new logo!

Dropbox joins the bandwagon of updating logos and no one noticed!
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smartphone using the speaker as a power bank. The ones that sport this ability are the JBL Charge 2, Creative Sound Blaster Roar, B&O Beolit 15 and the JBL Xtreme.

Some of the speakers have the ability to pair with another



Logitech x50

speaker (either from the same family, or the exact same model) to give you stereo output. The ones that support this are the JBL Flip 3, Creative Sound Blaster Roar, Logitech UE Boom and the JBL Xtreme.

Coming to other features of the speakers, the JBL Charge 2 has a Social Mode button, that allows up to three devices to connect to it via Bluetooth. Users can take turns playing music on the device, making the speaker a more social affair.

Never judge a book by its cover, and that's the best way to describe the features of the Creative Sound Blaster Roar. The company has thrown every feature possible in this speaker, except for AirPlay and the kitchen sink. The speaker works as a DAC. You can simply connect it to a PC through USB, and use this feature. Sure, it has Bluetooth, NFC and a microSD card slot, but did you know that you can record audio on it to a microSD card? Yes, you can. We found the feature online and tried it, and it works – the device can work as

a microSD card reader when it is plugged into a PC. There is a button at the back of the Roar, that says 'alarm'. Press this for three seconds and a siren sound plays from it very loudly. Living in Delhi, there are a lot of reasons why we can recommend carrying this speaker around, for this one function alone.

Coming to the B&O, two devices can be paired with the speaker at once. This allows the user and a friend, to play music together.

Everything written above seems great but the primary function of a Bluetooth speaker is to deliver great sound output. Does it succeed? Read on.

PERFORMANCE

Kicking things off with the budget speakers, we have the Frontech JIL3906. One annoying feature is that the Volume button, that, instead of controlling volume, changes the track. Controlling the volume is from the device (smartphone) only, unless you stop playing music, press the volume button a few times, and resume playback. Coming to the performance, there is practically no bass, but the vocals are clear. At its highest volume, the audio is still quite soft. Since the vocals are clear, the speaker is good for receiving calls. For the price you pay, it can not really be tagged 'bad'. This is the speaker you get your kids, because you won't be worried about them losing it.

Moving to the Logitech X50, the speaker is loud, clear, smooth, and can connect to two devices at the same time. There is a big jump in quality and loudness, when compared to the Frontech JIL 3906. The vocals are comparatively clear too, on the speaker. On the downside, the mids are subdued, and overall, the output audio has a lot of distortion. There is a distinct

lack of bass in the speakers. The speaker is loud and good enough for a small party, but if you want crisp detail in your audio, you will need to look elsewhere.

Coming to the Logitech X300, the speaker has very clear mids, and has an overall good range. When you expect the sound to become loud and deliver a punch, the speaker auto-levels the bump of the highs. This works well in some cases, while in a number of cases, the punch is vividly missing. This feature of the speaker is subjective to how you like your music. It has good stereo separation. This is the first budget speaker where there is considerable semblance of bass, which is good at this price point. The speaker has warm texture of audio notes, and details of the drum's beat are clear

X2 is only good enough for casual listening nothing more.

Coming to the JBL Charge 2, the speaker is well balanced, and has pronounced mids, leading the cue of well balanced audio performance. The speaker delivers the relevant punch when it's needed in the song, and that's a very good thing. The bass sounds a little 'dirty', but is distinct, nonetheless. To put things into perspective, distortion levels on the Charge 2 are higher than the X300. It does not completely destroy the experience, but it still is there. At maximum volume, this is not the loudest speaker we have, but it is loud enough, nonetheless. At high volumes, the speaker is tuned to favour bass and attenuates other frequencies. These speakers are excellent for outdoor listening.



B&O Beolit 15

and balanced. Overall, the audio from this speaker is quite good, especially considering its price.

The Sony SRS X2 sounds flat, but it is clear. The speaker has very high treble, to the point where it screeches at full volume. When there are a lot of instruments playing, the speaker sounds chaotic more than clear. Instruments aren't balanced with the vocals making the sounds too muddled. The SRS

The Bose SoundLink Color has really good range, especially in the frequency test. There is slight bass distortion but the speaker has very clear audio while listening to the snares and the hi-hats of Carnival. Put simply, it delivers reasonably balanced audio. On the downside, the mid-range frequencies are compromised. Although the overall audio output is clear, the audio delivery is unidirectional,